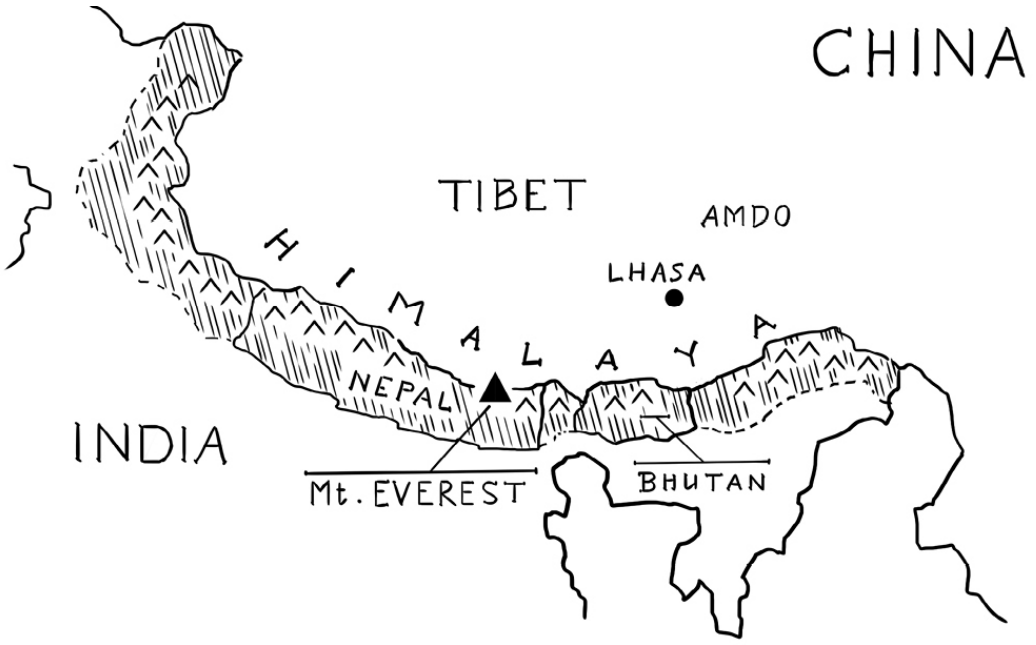
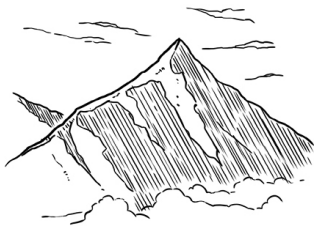
Roof of the World



Most of Tibet is a plateau—a high, flat area of land—on the continent of Asia. Tibet's longest borders are with Nepal and India. It is ringed by mountains. The snow-capped Himalayas, including Mount Everest, which rises 29,028 feet above sea level, form its southern border. Because Tibet has some of the highest land on Earth, it's often called the Roof of the World.



Lhamo rode in a palanquin (say: pal-uhn-KEEN), a fancy box, like a small room, that was made of yellow fabric and carried by horses. Out the palanquin's windows, he saw sights he had never seen before. He passed lakes, mountains, valleys, plains, and lots of animals: herds of wild yaks, flocks of geese, and wild donkeys. Lhamo was sometimes a troublemaker on the trip. When he was bored, he nagged and fought with his brother, Lobsang, who rode along with him.